

RQ: How do Fox News and The New York Times differ in their stylistic framing of the death of George Floyd, with respect to agency attribution, grammatical voice, epistemic hedging, and lexical choice?

Methodology

8 articles (3 Fox-original, 5 NYT-original), May 25–June 8 2020. spaCy dependency parser. Four CDA devices: transitivity, voice, hedging, lexical framing.

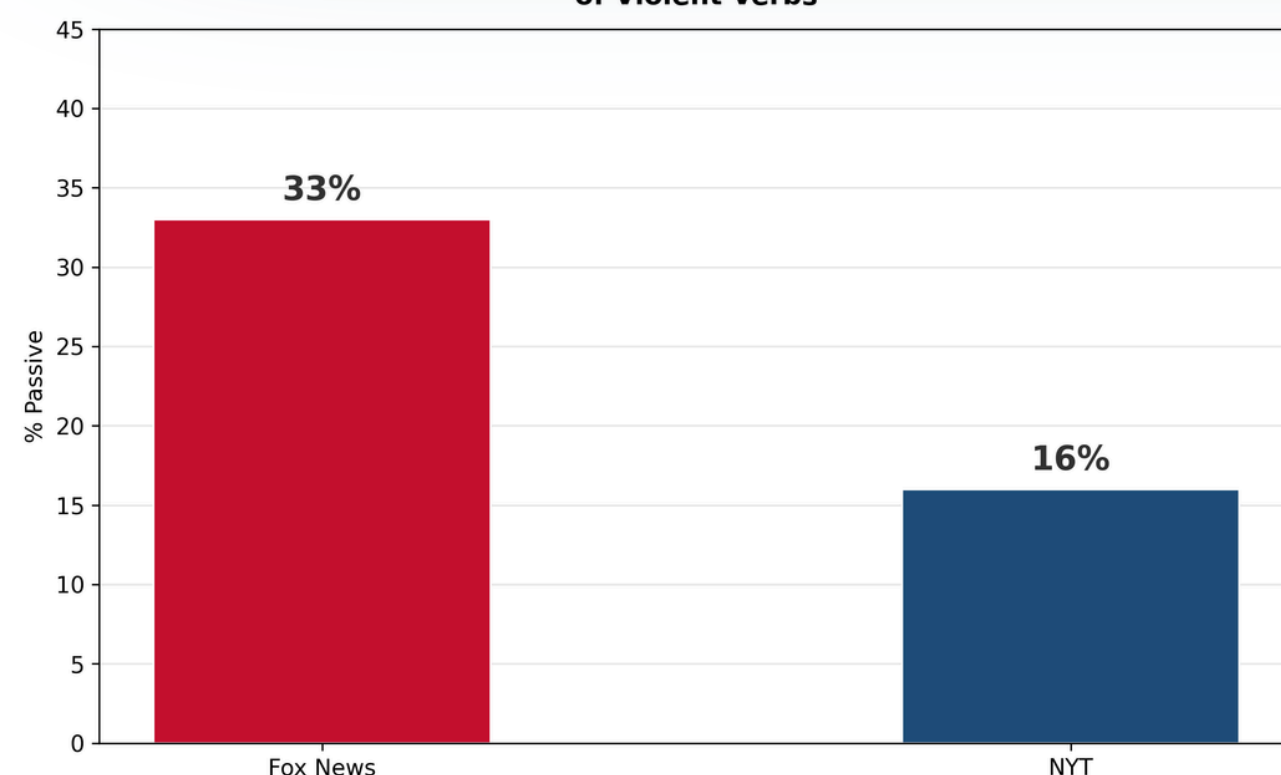


The New York Times

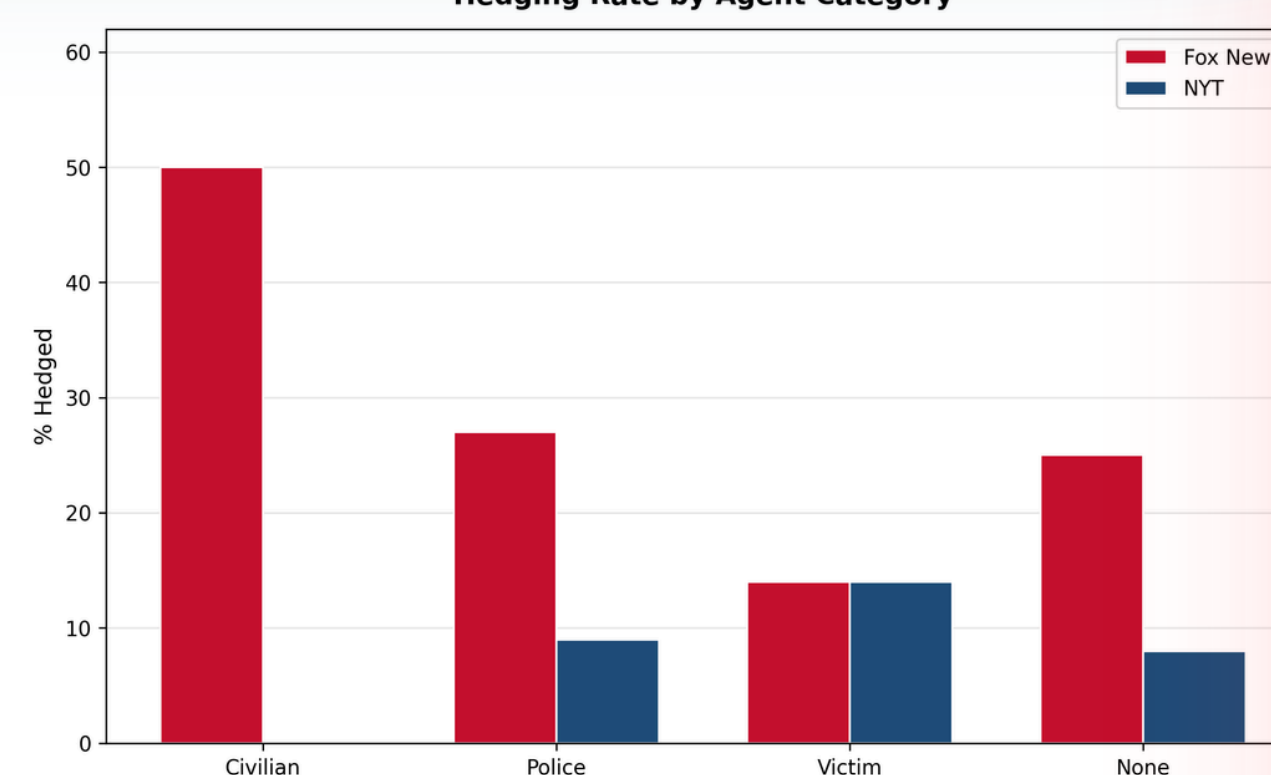
Key Findings

- Fox passivizes police-agent clauses 2× more than NYT (33% vs 16%)
- Fox hedges police-agent clauses 3× more than NYT (27% vs 9%)
- NYT names Floyd as patient of violent verbs (22%); Fox does not (0%)
- Fox attributes violence to civilians (13%); NYT does not (0%)
- NYT uses 14 institutional euphemisms; Fox uses 0
- $\chi^2(4) = 8.07$, $p = 0.089$ ($n=191$ verb-instances, 8 articles).

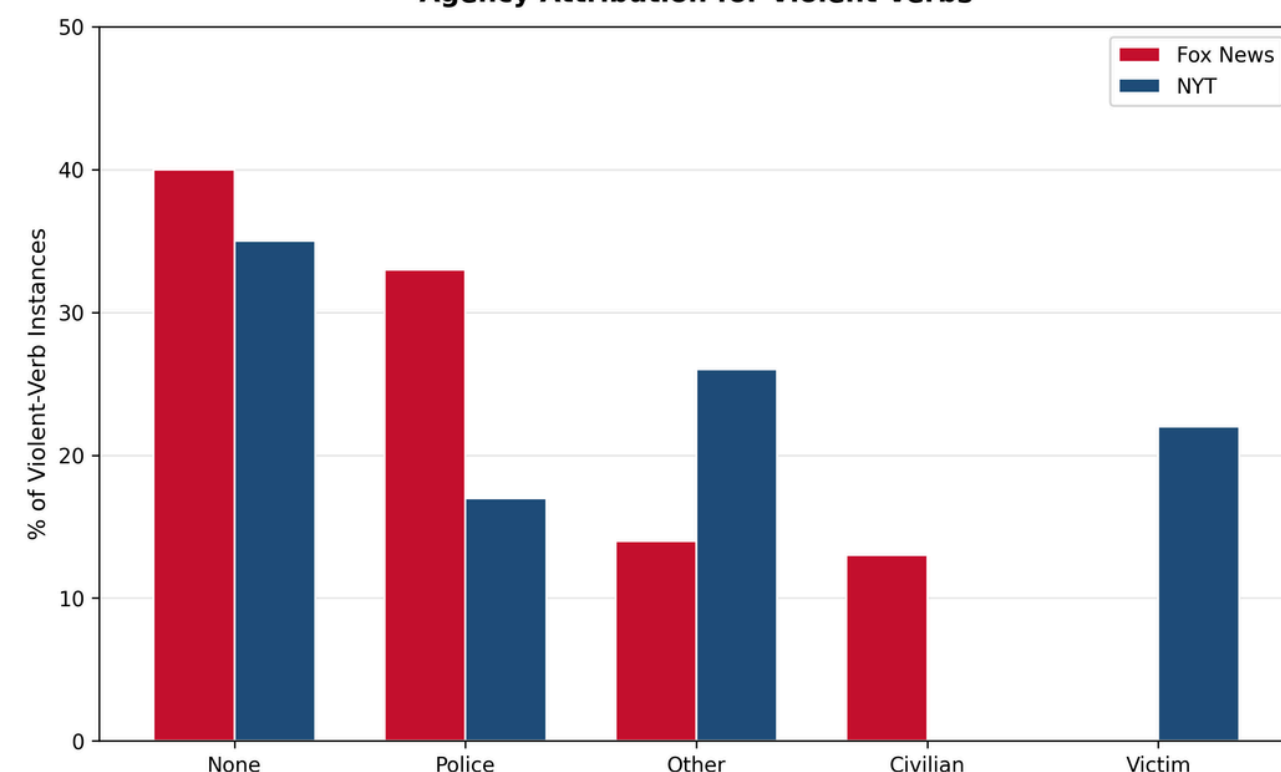
Passive Voice When Police Are Agent of Violent Verbs



Hedging Rate by Agent Category



Agency Attribution for Violent Verbs



Euphemism vs. Direct Phrase Frequency

